

ENG520

CREATING FIXED-CHOICE TEST ITEMS: TRUE/FALSE AND ITS USES

True/False Items:

- A statement is given, and the test taker marks it as either "true" or "false."
- Example: "The sun rises in the west. True or False?"

Uses of True/False Items:

- Great for quickly assessing basic knowledge, facts, or concepts.
- Used in quizzes, exams, or surveys to check comprehension.

Advantages of True/False Items:

- Quick to write, easy to grade.
- Covers a wide range of material in less time.

Limitations:

- May encourage guessing since there's a 50% chance of guessing correctly.
- Does not test deeper understanding.

Suggestions for Constructing True/False Items:

- Write clear, straightforward statements.
- Avoid double negatives or tricky wording.
- Make sure only one idea is presented in each statement.

CREATING FIXED-CHOICE TEST ITEMS: MATCHING EXERCISES

Matching Exercises:

- Two columns are presented; students match items from one column to another.
- Example: Column A: Countries, Column B: Capitals.

Uses:

- Useful for testing associations, such as definitions, names, or facts.

- Example: Match authors with their famous works.

Advantages:

- Compact and efficient for testing related concepts.
- Easy to grade.

Limitations:

- May confuse students if options in columns are too similar.
- Can become a guessing game if there are too many options.

Suggestions for Constructing Matching Exercises:

- Keep the lists balanced and related.
- Use clear and concise terms.
- Include extra options to reduce guessing.

CREATING FIXED-CHOICE TEST ITEMS: SHORT QUESTIONS

Short Answer/Completion Questions:

- Students provide brief responses to open-ended prompts.
- Example: "What is the capital of France?"

Uses:

- Ideal for testing factual knowledge or key concepts.

Advantages:

- Encourages recall rather than recognition.
- Easier to write compared to essay questions.

Suggestions for Constructing Short Answer Questions:

- Be specific and clear in the question.
- Avoid ambiguity to ensure accurate responses.
- Indicate the expected length of the answer if necessary.

CREATING CONSTRUCTED RESPONSE TEST ITEMS

Constructed Response Items:

- Students create their answers rather than choosing from given options.

Guidelines for Restricted Response Items:

- Provide clear instructions with specific limitations (e.g., "Explain in 50 words").
- Focus on targeted content to avoid confusion.

CREATING EXTENDED RESPONSE TEST ITEMS

Extended Response Items:

- Open-ended questions requiring detailed, essay-style answers.
- Example: "Discuss the importance of environmental conservation."

Guidelines for Writing Essay Items:

- Use prompts that encourage critical thinking.
- Be clear about the scope and structure of the answer.

Scoring Rubrics for Essay Items:

- Holistic Scoring Rubric: Provides an overall score based on general quality.
- Analytic Scoring Rubric: Breaks the score into specific criteria (e.g., content, grammar).

ANALYZING THE TEST

Item Analysis:

- Examines how individual test items perform, such as their difficulty and discrimination.

Key Concepts:

- Item Difficulty: Measures how easy or hard a question is.
- Item Discrimination: Shows how well an item differentiates between strong and weak students.

Item Response Theory (IRT):

- Advanced approach to analyze test items, focusing on individual performance and item properties.

ADMINISTERING TESTS

- Refers to organizing and conducting tests.
- Steps include assembling, packing, reproducing, and ensuring smooth administration.

Things to Remember:

- Provide clear instructions.
- Prepare backup materials for emergencies.

SCORING TESTS

Scoring Rubric:

- A guide to evaluate and grade responses consistently.

Types:

- Holistic Rubric: Overall impression.
- Analytic Rubric: Breaks down into detailed components (e.g., content, organization).

STANDARDIZED TESTS

Standardized Tests:

- Pre-designed tests given under controlled conditions to measure student achievement.

Characteristics:

- Uniform administration.
- Reliable and valid results.

Criterion-Referenced Interpretation:

- Compares performance to a set standard.

Norm-Referenced Interpretation:

- Compares performance to other test takers.

HIGH STAKES TESTING AND ISSUES

High-Stakes Testing (HST):

- Tests that have significant consequences, such as college admissions.

Issues:

- Pressure on students and educators.
- Risk of focusing too much on test preparation.

Recommendations for Effective HST:

- Align tests with curriculum goals.
- Provide preparation resources for students.

